

World Bank World Development Report: Data for Better Lives

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Chapter 1: The New Social Contract for Data in Developing Economies

Data has emerged as an unprecedented economic asset capable of improving public service delivery and economic productivity.

The report proposes an integrated social contract for data founded on three fundamental pillars: Value, Trust, and Equity.

Trust requires establishing robust data protection laws, cybersecurity safeguards, and independent regulatory oversight authorities.

Without trust, citizens and businesses resist data sharing, reducing the economic value generated from collective data assets.

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Chapter 2: Value Capture Disparities between Global North and South

Lower-middle-income countries currently capture less than 15% of the total economic value derived from their domestic data flows.

Global platform monopolies based in high-income economies capture dominant shares of digital advertising and cloud service revenues.

Developing countries face severe infrastructure deficits, with average broadband penetration remaining under 35% across rural areas.

National statistical offices require modernization and sustainable financing to produce high-frequency socioeconomic metrics.

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Chapter 3: Enablers of Open Data and Cross-Border Governance

Governments should establish open data policies that make non-sensitive public data freely accessible in machine-readable formats.

Cross-border data flow governance requires interoperable legal frameworks that protect privacy while preventing digital protectionism.

Investment in national data centers and Internet Exchange Points (IXPs) reduces international transit costs by up to 40%.

Antitrust and competition policies must be updated to address anti-competitive network effects in concentrated digital markets.